

Glorious King of Tantras of the Vow of the Net of Vajra Accomplishment

Śrī Vajrasiddha Jāla Saṃvara Tantra Rāja · Toh 411 · Derge Kangyur

དཔལ་རྩོུ་ཐུ་པ་དྲུ་འུ་ཐུ་པ་དྲུ་འུ་ཐུ་པ་

Toh 411 in the Kangyur is a tantric scripture known in Sanskrit as the Śrī Vajrasiddha Jāla Saṃvara Tantra Rāja and in Tibetan as the Dpal Rdo rje grub pa dra ba'i sdom pa'i rgyud kyi rgyal po, rendered in English as The Glorious King of Tantras of the Vow of the Net of Vajra Accomplishment. It belongs to the class of Highest Yoga Tantras associated with the Cakrasaṃvara or Saṃvara cycle, concerning the sacred vows, esoteric practices, and the assembly of heroes and yoginīs within a tantric maṇḍala framework. The text opens with the Buddha residing in the Tuṣita heaven alongside the bodhisattva Maitreya and a vast retinue, and proceeds to expound teachings on the illusory lineage and the outer, inner, and secret offerings of unsurpassed worship. It was translated into Tibetan by the scholar Śākya Yeshé and is preserved among the tantric texts of the Kangyur.

Translated by Śākya Yeshé.

In the language of India: Śrī Vajrasiddha Jāla Saṃvara Tantra Rāja. In the Tibetan language: The Glorious King of Tantras of the Vow of the Net of Vajra Accomplishment.

Homage to the Glorious Vajra Ḍākinī.

Thus did I hear. At one time, the Blessed One was dwelling within the precious mansion of Tuṣita, together with the bodhisattva Maitreya (Loving-Kindness), Joyous Light, Stainless Light, and an immeasurable retinue of heroes and yoginīs. At that time, when all the Tathāgatas had entered meditative equipoise in the bhaga of the queen who is suchness itself, and were exercising lordship over the illusory lineage, and all were being worshipped with the outer, inner, and secret, unsurpassed divine offerings, the bodhisattva Maitreya prostrated with his head at the feet of the Blessed One, joined his palms together, and made this request in verse:

O Protector, possessed of great compassion,
whatever is the ultimate suchness,
the meaning of Śrī and vajra,
and the meaning of the tantra of the vow of the net,

whatever the vow taught by that —
pray explain that suchness to me.

The Blessed One declared:

Maitreya and all the retinue assembled:
gather the mind distracted toward outer things
within, and listen with one-pointed attention.

Śrī is non-dual wisdom;
that suchness is worthy of worship,
and is to be worshipped with non-dual bliss.

Vajra means the five wisdoms:
because they cannot be split by the conceptuality
of apprehended and apprehender,
they are taught as vajra.

By remaining one-pointedly in that suchness,
one will certainly attain the ground
of the great dharmakāya Vajradhara.

Net means the meaning of multiplicity:
taught as the knowledge of another on the conventional level,
the extensive teaching of the many categories
is the meaning of the vow equal to space.

Self-awareness equal to space
is the taste of emptiness, the suchness of mind.
The very continuum of those moments
is what is taught as tantra.

This is the first chapter of the Glorious Vajra Accomplishment, the King of
Tantras of the Vow of the Net, which sets forth the tantra of the title.

Then further, I shall explain:
the cause and abode of the arising of wisdom,
the condition, and likewise the object of focus,
the synonyms of particular names
and the synonyms of meaning,
the benefit and the fruit,
and the ultimate suchness, the dharmadhātu —
all of this shall here be explained.

The cause is self-aware wisdom:
it has the nature of a cause that lacks an [external] cause.
Self-awareness arising as illusion
begins from the wheel of great bliss.
The wheels are explained as four, or as eight plus two,
and likewise as twenty-four;
they are the support for the arising of wisdom.

The abode is the channel equal to that.
The companion is the wind of wisdom,
and riding upon the mount of the wisdom-wind,
suchness arises from that very riding.
The count is to be known as before.
The essential nature is the bindu itself;
know the bindu in terms of the count of its knots.

Whatever is the benefit of this:
it is the abandonment of conceptuality
that is conceived in an inverted manner
through the conceptuality of apprehended and apprehender.

The fruit is that one will certainly attain
the ground of the great Vajradhara.

This is the second chapter of the Glorious Vajra Net Vow Tantra, the chapter on
the cause and abode of wisdom and related topics.

Then further, what is to be explained:
the divisions of the wheels.

The petals of the wheel of great bliss
number thirty-two.
The wheel of enjoyment
is taught as having sixteen petals.
The wheel of Dharma has eight petals.
The petals of the emanation wheel
are sixty-four.

The wheel of great bliss has four finger-widths.
The wheel of enjoyment has sixteen finger-widths.
The wheel of Dharma has twelve finger-widths.
The emanation wheel has sixteen finger-widths.

At the hub of the wheel of great bliss,
visualize the syllable Hūṃ, white and facing downward.

At the center of the wheel of enjoyment,
visualize Oṃ, red and facing upward.

At the center of the wheel of Dharma,
visualize Hūṃ as blue and facing downward.

At the hub of the emanation wheel,
visualize Āḥ as red and facing upward.

On the petals of the first wheel,
place the sixteen vowel syllables
in both forward and reverse order.

On the petals of the wheel of enjoyment,
place the sixteen vowel syllables in sequence.

On the petals of the wheel of Dharma,
place these syllables: Lāṃ, Māṃ, Pāṃ, Tāṃ —
these are arranged from the left.

Oṃ, Trī, Hrī, A —

these are placed to the right from the intermediate directions.

On the four spokes of each petal of the emanation wheel,
place the thirty-two consonant syllables
in both forward and reverse order.

The three channels of body, speech, and mind
abide straight from the center.

Hūṃ, white and facing downward,
is placed so as to reach the lower tip.

To the right is the channel of skillful means,
wherein the thirty-two syllables of the Kālī
are wound three times around the channel of means,
placed facing downward in forward order.

To the left is the channel of wisdom,
wherein the sixteen vowel syllables of the Mātṛkā
are placed facing upward.

Resting at the vertebrae, sustained by the vital breath,
at the place where the three channels converge,
there abides, bent like a precious gem, in nine forms with the aspect of a bird's

face,
the Lady Sovereign of the dharmadhātu,
the bestower of the bliss of touch.

Furthermore, the two wheels of condition:
at the triangular place, the syllable Raṃ —
from its complete transformation arises
a triangular wheel of fire,
measuring three finger-widths.
At the navel, visualize Raṃ as red.
On the three petals, place Oṃ, Āḥ, Hūṃ.
At the three corners of the triangle,
visualize a three-pointed vajra.

At the place of wind, the syllable Yaṃ —
from its very transformation arises
a form resembling a dark bow,
measuring four finger-widths,
with five petals at the center.
At the navel, visualize Yaṃ as black.
On the five petals, place five Dha syllables.
It is marked with five pennants.

By the wind kindling the samaya fire,
and by the samaya fire arousing the caṇḍālī,
the three wheels are scorched and heated,
and the syllable Haṃ, being melted,
dissolves and falls as a rain of nectar.
At the place of the navel it transforms into a drop.
Blazing there without ceasing,
it enters into what resembles the form of a precious gem,
and through experiencing natural joy,
the essence-taste of one's own mind —
the glorious Heruka of the fourth —
by realizing that very suchness,
one attains with certainty
the ground of the dharmakāya, the great Vajradhara.

This is the third chapter, teaching the four wheels, from the tantra of the net of
vows of the glorious Vajrasiddhi.

Then, furthermore, what is to be taught:
"Equal to a wish-fulfilling jewel,
I have spoken this in definitive meaning.
You all should hold its meaning
in mind with one-pointed attention."

When the Blessed One had spoken these words, Maitreya, Light of Joy, Light of Stainlessness, and the other heroes and yoginīs of the innumerable retinue all rejoiced and were delighted, and expressing their approval they made offerings of many kinds of divine worship: a rain of precious gems in the sky, and offerings of playful celebration, laughter, and joy, along with the offering of paṭaha drums and the like, and further offerings of divine flowers, incense, butter lamps, and food — the offering of a hundred flavors — and offerings of drink. Beyond these, they offered the inner, secret, and supremely secret unsurpassed great offering, wondrous and extraordinary. Having made these offerings, they circumambulated three times, and then, each by their own miraculous power, became invisible.

The glorious king of the tantra of the net of vows of Vajrasiddhi —

Translator's Notes

- The passage breaks off mid-sentence at the end, as the source text provided ends abruptly during the third chapter's description of the wheel of Dharma's central syllable.

The phrase "entering meditative equipoise in the bhaga of the queen who is suchness itself" is a standard tantric locution describing the yab-yum union of the Tathāgatas with their consorts. Bhaga is retained untranslated as a technical tantric term referring to the consort's lotus, the seat of non-dual bliss. Rendering it circumspectly in English prose risks obscuring the doctrinal content, which the tradition understands as the union of wisdom and method.

"Joyous Light" and "Stainless Light" render the Tibetan names Dga' ba'i 'od and Dri ma med pa'i 'od respectively; these are bodhisattva names in the assembly.

The phrase "exercising lordship over the illusory lineage" renders rigs sgyu ma'i dbang du mdzad de, a tantric technical expression indicating that the Tathāgatas were displaying the magical, illusory display of their lineage's nature.

- The "Kālī" syllables refer to the thirty-two consonants of the Sanskrit alphabet in tantric usage, where the consonants are termed Kālikā or Kālī-varṇa in contradistinction to the vowels called Mātṛkā. This is standard in Indo-Tibetan tantric syllable-placement practice and the rendering follows that convention.

The phrase rendered "the Lady Sovereign of the dharmadhātu, the bestower of the bliss of touch" identifies a specific deity associated with the navel cakra in this system; the nine forms with the aspect of a bird's face is a standard iconographic description of caṇḍālī-related deities in this class of tantra.

The "fourth" in "the glorious Heruka of the fourth" refers to the fourth joy (the innate joy, sahaḥjānanda), the highest of the four joys in the Anuttarayoga system.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.